

4.2 Using Microsoft Office PowerPoint 2003

Now that we are all worked up on using PowerPoint, let us start with a few small steps. We will first look at starting up PowerPoint, creating your first presentation, saving it and finally making a presentation to an audience.

4.2.1 Why PowerPoint?

PowerPoint can be used to make interactive, interesting presentations that will grab your audience's attention. Another point in PowerPoint's favour is that it can be changed on-the-go, with the newer features. Nevertheless, do not think that PowerPoint is always *the* solution to opt for. No software can beat traditional blackboard and chalk in a math class with its problem-solving, one-to-many sessions between a genius teacher and his eager-to-learn students! PowerPoint is not the tool for such a setting and it's best to stick to the tried and tested.

4.2.2 About PowerPoint2003

PowerPoint 2003 consistently maintains the look-and-feel of the Windows XP environment. Buttons are more coloured, as are the menus and toolbars. The first time you start PowerPoint, you will be greeted with the now-friendly 'Task Pane' offering you helpful options to create your first presentation.

4.2.3 Views in PowerPoint

Understanding the different views in PowerPoint is extremely important. This is because you can toggle between different views, using the toggling to your advantage. Another factor that makes it important is that you should know when to use what view. During a slideshow, it can turn very embarrassing if you fumble when switching views.

When you start PowerPoint, the default view is the 'Normal' view with the task pane on the right-hand side of the monitor, the 'Notes' pane at the bottom and the 'Slide/Outline' pane at the left.